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Application No.: 23 169 431.6

The application and the invention to which it relates seem to meet the requirements of the EPC. Upon presence of a valid request for examination and consideration by the examining division, a communication under Rule 71(3) EPC may be issued.

The further procedure with respect to this application is dependent upon the result of the search for prior art under Article 54(3) EPC* which will be carried out at least 18 months from the date of filing of the application under consideration. If such prior art is found, a communication under Rule 71(1) EPC will be sent. The communication under Rule 71(3) EPC can be issued only after that search has been carried out and if no such prior art is found.

* It is to be noted that Article 54(4) EPC 1973 continues to apply to European patent applications still pending, filed before 13.12.2007